



**GREEN
CLIMATE
FUND**

Readiness and Preparatory Support

Direct Access Proposal Template

DAE Support Window

Proposal title

Please provide a proposal title. The title should include the country name(s) and a brief description of the subject. Avoid generic titles like “First Readiness Grant” and use a proposal-specific title instead.

Direct Access Entity

Type here

How to complete this template?

This proposal template is designed for Direct Access by Direct Access Entities (DAEs) for the DAE Support Window.

To assist with completing this proposal template, the GCF provides the following guiding documents available on the GCF website:

[!\[\]\(a870788d6ed9b8fd294b7654a8c8526b_img.jpg\) **Guide for Direct Access Entities to Access Readiness Support**](#)

[!\[\]\(de95854c7ee024cfadc48187bbb781b2_img.jpg\) **Guide for Direct Access Entities on Strategic Planning of Readiness Support**](#)

If the DAE opts for the Direct Access option under the DAE window¹, there is no need to complete the FMCA questionnaire, as accreditation already verifies the entity's financial capacity.

While this template allows DAEs to prepare the direct access proposal offline, please note that all information must be entered and officially submitted through the online submission platform in the **GCF Partner Portal**.

How to get support to complete this template?

If you are not sure how to complete the proposal, or require support, please send an email to the relevant GCF regional team. Please refer to the GCF website to identify the relevant GCF regional team.

¹ Within the DAE window, funding is provided to assist accredited DAEs as well as candidate DAEs in the advanced stages of the accreditation process. For candidate DAEs, this refers to the stage of resolving outstanding accreditation conditions subsequent to the Board's approval of accreditation.

Proposal Details

Title of the Direct Access Proposal

Please provide a proposal title. The title should include the country name(s) and a brief description of the subject. Avoid generic titles like “Fist Readiness Grant” and use a proposal-specific title instead.

Total Requested Amount (in USD)

Please specify the total requested amount in USD. This amount must exactly match the total budget outlined in the budget tab of the Financial Proposal Excel Template.

Implementation Period (in months)

The implementation period begins on the effective date of the grant and encompasses an inception phase and an implementation phase.

Country Information

☐ Single DAE

☐ Multi-DAE

Lead DAE

Contact person

Position

Email

Additional email addresses that need to be copied in correspondences

Type of Access

☐ Direct Access by DAE



☐ Framework Agreement Partner

Provide name of the partner

Participating DAE Information

If the proposal involves multiple DAEs (multi-DAE), please list each one below, adding as many rows as necessary. The entry listed above serves as the lead for the multi-DAE proposal.

Participating DAE	Name of contact person	Contact person's position	Contact person's email	Budget

1. Summary of the proposal

Please include an executive summary that presents the specific objectives the proposal is trying to achieve, context, alignment with GCF objectives, as well as expected impact and results.

2. DAE Context

Guidance

This section provides an overview of the DAE context, including institutional capacity and accreditation status, priority areas for funding by the GCF and programming capacity. It also highlights the DAE's key challenges, pipeline as well as readiness needs and stakeholder engagement.

2.1 Institutional Context and Accreditation Track

Project/programme size

- ☐ Micro (<10mn)
- ☐ Small (10-50mn)
- ☐ Medium (50-250mn)
- ☐ Large (>250mn)

Environmental & social risk category

- ☐ A/I-1 (high)
- ☐ B/I-2 (medium)
- ☐ C/I-3 (minimal or no)

Financing modalities

- ☐ Basic
- ☐ Project management
- ☐ Grant
- ☐ On-lending and/or blending (loans, equity and/or guarantees)

Please provide details on accreditation scope and scale and provide an overview of the DAE institutional context.

Accreditation stage

- ☐ AMA yet to be signed
- ☐ AMA yet to be made effective
- ☐ AMA is signed and effective

Access to the readiness resources under the DAE window is provided once the accreditation decision is taken by the Board. Please indicate the following details, by clicking an appropriate box and provide detail of your accreditation status (for example, which conditions are pending for AMA effectiveness, etc. (max 200 words)

2.2 Entity Climate Priorities and Programming Capacity

Please briefly identify DAE's climate priorities and programming capacity.



2.3 Past and Ongoing Readiness Grants (GCF and non-GCF) and PPF support

Please list past and current GCF readiness grants, and relevant capacity-building initiatives funded by other agencies and funds

GCF Readiness and PPF Activities

Title & Reference Number	Start and End Dates	Amount approved	Status	Objectives	Key Outcomes & Results	Complementarity with the readiness proposal
Type title here Type reference # here	Click to enter a date - Click to enter a date		Choose an item			
Type title here Type reference # here	Click to enter a date - Click to enter a date		Choose an item			

Other Capacity-Building Initiatives Funded or Commissioned by Parties Other Than GCF

Title	Start and End Dates	Status	Funding Agency	Main objectives	Complementarity with the readiness proposal
Type title here	Click to enter a date - Click to enter a date	Choose an item			
Type title here	Click to enter a date - Click to enter a date	Choose an item			



2.4 Past and Ongoing Funded Activity Implementation and Project Pipeline

Please briefly describe GCF-funded proposals/projects or programmes that the DAE has implemented, is currently implementing, and is in the process of conceptualising and preparing

GCF Funded Activities

Project title	Status	Amount	Details	Complementarity with the readiness proposal
Type title here Type reference # here	Choose an item			
Type title here Type reference # here	Choose an item			

2.5 Challenges, Gaps, and Barriers

Summarise the DAE's primary challenges, including any gaps or barriers experienced

2.6 Stakeholder Engagement

Please briefly reflect on the level of engagement with key stakeholders, including government, local communities, indigenous peoples, etc.

2.7 Specific Readiness Needs

Please briefly outline the readiness needs identified

3. Statement of Objectives

Guidance

This section aims to clearly define the objectives and scope of readiness support being sought. It outlines: (1) the anticipated impact of readiness support to establish and advance DAEs' capacities to effectively programme, implement and report on GCF-funded activities, as well as broader climate finance, and (2) specific areas of readiness support required, addressing capacity gaps and aligning with the objectives and outcomes of the 2024-2027 readiness strategy.

3.1 Objectives of the Readiness Support

Please provide a narrative regarding the outcomes. To build the narrative, please consider the RRMF Handbook.

Clearly specify the objectives under this proposal and please select the outcomes below.

Objective 1. Capacity-building for climate finance coordination and setting up the enabling environment for integrated climate investment

- ☐ 1.3. Direct access applicants and accredited entities (DAEs) have met and maintained the accreditation standards of the GCF and strengthened their programming capacities, as evidenced by the development of GCF-funded activities.

Objective 2. Paradigm-shifting GCF pipeline development and implementation for adaptation and mitigation, based on country needs and guided by USP-2

- ☐ 2.2. Developing countries have developed high-quality concept notes linked to approved GCF proposals for adaptation and mitigation that are aligned with the USP-2 results, including through DAEs, that build on readiness support and country programmes.
- ☐ 2.3. NDAs and DAEs have enhanced processes and systems to effectively oversee the implementation, financial management, monitoring and reporting of climate programmes and projects.

Objective 3. Knowledge-sharing and learning to enhance national and regional cooperation on climate programming and financing

- ☐ 3.2. Enhanced collaboration among developing countries on climate change issues, evidenced by transboundary and regional cooperations/South-South cooperation.

3.2 Anticipated Impact on Direct Access Entity Climate Programming and Implementation Capacity

Describe the expected impact of readiness support on climate programming and direct access.

4. Approach, Methodology, and Implementation Activities

Guidance

Please describe technical approach, methodology, and implementation plan to address the country needs and gaps, through the Direct Access modality.

4.1 Theory of Change

The first step in articulating the programme's objectives as well as the logic behind the delivery of its intended results is the formulation of a TOC. Please provide a TOC which highlights key challenges being addressed, as well as the step-by-step pathways to achieving the expected results. Key steps to designing a TOC are outlined in the [RRMF Handbook](#).

4.2 Implementation Activities

Please list all proposed activities under their corresponding outputs. For each activity:

- Assign a unique identifier using the format aligned with the output (e.g., activities under Output 1.2.1 should be labelled as 1.2.1a, 1.2.1b, 1.2.1c, etc.).
- Ensure these activity labels match those referenced in the Financial Proposal to maintain consistency and traceability.
- Provide a clear and detailed description of each activity, specifying the exact actions that will be undertaken.

Objective 1. Capacity-building for climate finance coordination and setting up the enabling environment for integrated climate investment

- ☐ **Outcome 1.3.** Direct access applicants and accredited entities (DAEs) have met and maintained the accreditation standards of the GCF and strengthened their programming capacities, as evidenced by the development of GCF-funded activities
- ☐ **Output 1.3.1.** Institutional gaps of direct access applicants and accredited entities (DAEs) are addressed to obtain and/or maintain accreditation.

Activities

Type Activity 1.3.1.a here

Type Activity 1.3.1.b here

Objective 2. Paradigm-shifting GCF pipeline development and implementation for adaptation and mitigation, based on country needs and guided by USP-2 programming targets

- ☐ **Outcome 2.2.** Developing countries have developed high-quality Concept Notes linked to approved GCF proposals for adaptation and mitigation that are aligned with the USP-2 results (including through DAEs, that build on readiness support and Country Programmes)
- ☐ **Output 2.2.1.** NDA, DAEs and other climate stakeholders, have enhanced their capacity on Concept Note and/or Funding Proposal development for an inclusive integrated climate programming

Activities

Type Activity 2.2.1.a here

Type Activity 2.2.1.b here

- ☐ **Output 2.2.2.** Investment-grade Concept Notes and/or Funding Proposals that are fully aligned with the Country Programme and passed the GCF screening process

Activities

Type Activity 2.2.2.a here

Type Activity 2.2.2.b here

- ☐ **Outcome 2.3.** NDAs and DAEs have enhanced processes and systems to effectively oversee the implementation, financial management, monitoring and reporting of climate programmes and projects

- ☐ **Output 2.3.1.** NDA and DAEs have enhanced relevant capacity, processes and systems in place to oversee and implement climate programmes and projects

Activities

Type Activity 2.3.1.a here

Type Activity 2.3.1.b here

Objective 3. Knowledge-sharing and learning to enhance national and regional cooperation on climate programming and financing

- ☐ **Outcome 3.2.** Enhanced collaboration among developing countries on climate change issues, evidenced by transboundary and regional cooperations/South-South cooperation
- ☐ **Output 3.2.1.** Regional or South-South partnerships, programmes, policies, MOUs and/or collaboration mechanisms established among developing countries, including through their DAEs

Activities

Type Activity 3.2.1.a here

Type Activity 3.2.1.b here

4.3 Stakeholder Engagement Strategy

Please describe how relevant stakeholders ⓘ have been consulted to identify gaps, challenges and barriers, as well as proposed solutions, in the areas or sectors covered by this readiness proposal. Additionally, explain how these stakeholders will be engaged during the implementation of the readiness support and how their feedback and concerns will be addressed throughout the process. Enhanced stakeholder engagement is crucial as it fosters a greater sense of ownership among all involved parties.



4.4 Risk Assessment and Mitigation measures

Please describe potential risks and risk monitoring plan, as follows:

- Please list the key identified and potential risks as well as the mitigation measures proposed. The potential risks could include, for example, delays, disruptions, cost and market risks, inadequate coordination/participation, lack of political support, money-laundering/terrorist financing, and prohibited practices.
- Please indicate the probability of occurrence (low/medium/high) and impact level (low/medium/high) for each potential risk.
- If managed remotely, please describe the measures (mechanisms and controls) to be taken to identify, assess, monitor and mitigate any risk of money-laundering, terrorist financing or prohibited practices.
- Please describe the measures (mechanisms and controls) to be taken for activities within the proposal to identify, assess, monitor and mitigate any risk of money-laundering, terrorist financing, prohibited practices and other integrity matters.

Risk category	Specific risk(s) / Risk(s) description	Probability of occurrence	Impact level	Mitigation action(s)	Entity(ies) responsible to manage the risk(s)
Choose an item		Choose an item	Choose an item		
Choose an item		Choose an item	Choose an item		
Choose an item		Choose an item	Choose an item		

5. Logical Framework (output)

Guidance

Please complete the logical framework in the separate document.

6. Implementation Arrangements

6.1.1 Partnering under Direct Access

Please indicate whether implementing partners will be used for readiness support delivery and explain how they will ensure the success of the proposed activities. This may include entities, organizations and/or individual consultants directly contracted by the DAE.

Clearly articulate the roles and responsibilities of the DAE and any parties involved in delivering readiness support.

Briefly describe the financial capacity assessment done to entities or organizations identified to engage in this proposal (sub-recipients). If available at this stage, please attach the relevant capacity assessment report.

Specify the implementation approach and reporting mechanisms between the DAE and the sub-recipients. What is the role of the DAE in project implementation, ownership, decision-making and coordination strategies with these third parties? If multiple entities are involved, detail the contractual arrangements and the roles and responsibilities of each entity.

Describe the reporting mechanism to the GCF.

Please also describe implementation arrangements on the ground, existence of an office in the beneficiary country and approach to managing and oversight of the in-country implementation of the readiness activities.

Under the Direct Access modality, the GCF Secretariat will engage directly with the country through the DAE. The Secretariat will not be responsible for selecting or contracting third-party implementing partners, as this responsibility falls under the purview of the country.

6.1.2 Framework Agreements

Under the Direct Access modality, the DAE may use entities with existing Framework Readiness and Preparatory Support Grant Agreements (FWA holder) with the GCF Secretariat.

If an existing FWA holder is used, include a statement that this organization will be responsible for implementing the Direct Access Readiness support and will handle all fiduciary, financial management, monitoring and reporting activities in compliance with the signed FWA

Please provide justification on why the FWA holder was selected to fulfill the implementation arrangements under this Direct Access Proposal.

Please indicate whether the FWA holder will use implementing partners for readiness support delivery and explain how they will ensure the success of the proposed activities.

Clearly articulate the roles and responsibilities of the FWA holder and any parties involved in delivering readiness support.

Briefly describe the financial capacity assessment done to entities or organizations identified to engage in this proposal (sub-recipients). If available at this stage, please attach the relevant capacity assessment report.

Specify the implementation approach and reporting mechanisms between the FWA holder and the sub-recipients. If multiple entities are involved, detail the contractual arrangements and the roles and responsibilities of each entity.

Describe the reporting mechanism to the GCF.

Please also describe implementation arrangements on the ground, existence of an office in the beneficiary country and approach to managing and oversight of the in-country implementation of the readiness activities.

6.2 Organisation and Staffing

In this chapter, propose the structure and composition of your team. Consider including a visual depiction of the programme team through an organisational chart, depicting reporting responsibilities. List the main disciplines, key experts responsible, and technical and support staff, including their relevant past experience, using the form below.

Please also include any details on any other relevant group of stakeholders, such as steering committees, technical teams, tasks force, coordination mechanisms, PMC structure, etc.

For these groups, describe their composition, decision-making processes, operational procedures, terms of reference (if any) and how the DAE will manage or oversee these units to ensure fulfillment of its obligations.

Name of staff	Organisation	Area of expertise	Position Assigned	Task Assigned	Base Country During Assignment

6.3 Fund flow arrangements

Describe the fund flow arrangements for the project, including the details of the dedicated USD account for receiving funds, the project account in local currency (if applicable), and how transfers will be made between these accounts. Explain the measures that will be taken to manage exchange rate risks throughout the project period, and attach a simple diagram showing the complete flow of funds.

7. Monitoring, Evaluation and Reporting

Guidance

The RRMF has been revised to align with the objectives and outcomes outlined in the 2024-2027 readiness strategy, with the view to (1) simplify and streamline monitoring and reporting procedures; (ii) appropriately capture and reflect the systemic approach and strategic, programme-based methodology for planning and implementing readiness support; and (iii) establish a clear connection between readiness support and the enhanced programming capacities of developing countries and DAEs to effectively access and utilise climate finance.

Please note that there are as per the Revised RRMF, there are two levels of monitoring and reporting. The first is at the programme/project level, and the second is at the Country level. Outlined below are the monitoring and reporting requirements and responsible parties.

7.1 Programme Monitoring and Reporting (Output-Level)

Responsibility & Tasks:

- In the case of direct access, the DAE or a Framework Agreement (FWA) holder is responsible for monitoring the programme/project's implementation and preparing relevant reports that detail the progress of output-level results and deliverables as articulated in the programme/project logframe.

Financial Reporting:

- Regular financial reporting is the principal reporting mechanism under Readiness. Reports should provide an overview of funds received and expended and a comparison of planned versus actual expenditure with rationale for any variances. All financial reports must be presented in USD, in line with the approved programme budget. The detailed reporting requirements, including content and format, will be specified in the implementation-related templates.

Reporting Frequency:

- Annual progress reports, including financial reporting, are to be submitted to the GCF Secretariat by 31 March of each year, unless otherwise agreed to in the respective legal agreements. Upon project closure, a completion report must be submitted within three months of the completion of the activities

☐ By checking this box, I acknowledge awareness of reporting tasks, including frequency and content

7.2 Financial Audits

Responsibility:

- Independent, third-party auditor commissioned by [choose appropriate] the DAE or FWA holder in case of direct access, or by the delivery partner if chosen from the GCF pre-qualified pool through mini-tenders.

Task:

- Regular financial audits to ensure responsible and transparent fund management, preventing misuse or mismanagement and ensuring compliance with GCF and national requirements.

Reporting Frequency:

- Annual financial audit reports must be submitted to the GCF Secretariat by 31 March of each calendar year, unless an alternative frequency and deadline is agreed upon at the conclusion of the legal agreement. The completion financial audit report to be submitted to the GCF Secretariat within three months of completing the activities.

Please confirm which type of auditor will be selected and provide any details

☐ Private Auditor

- ☐ Public Auditor (such as Country Supreme Audit Institution (SAI) or other)

Provide more details

Provide fiscal calendar year

- ☐ By checking this box, I acknowledge awareness of financial audit responsibilities, including frequency

7.3 Mid-Term Review (if the programme is four years)

This will align with the Year 2 annual progress report; a separate mid-term report is not required. Instead, a specific section in the Year 2 annual progress report will focus on the assessment of the adequacy of the initial design of the four-year programmes, the evaluation of the progress made towards achieving project objectives, and the review of the effectiveness of the delivery partner (if selected from the GCF pre-qualified pool). It will also identify any challenges encountered. The findings from this review will be used to make necessary adjustments to the project implementation plan in Years 3-4.

- ☐ By checking this box, I acknowledge awareness of reporting tasks, including frequency and content

7.4 Final Evaluation

Responsibility:

- An independent evaluator will be commissioned by the DAE, or a FWA holder, in case of direct access

Task:

- Upon completion of the project implementation period, an independent evaluation will be conducted to assess the overall impact of the readiness activities. This evaluation will measure the contribution of these activities to the country's objectives and GCF outcomes, guided by the GCF Evaluation Policy and Standards. It will include an impact assessment and document lessons learned to inform future project planning and readiness support. If the country selects two programmes, the GCF Secretariat and the country may consult to explore the rationale and feasibility of conducting a single evaluation for both programmes.

Reporting Frequency:

- The final evaluation report will be submitted to the GCF Secretariat within three months of completing the Readiness activities.

- ☐ By checking this box, I acknowledge awareness of reporting tasks, including frequency and content

7.5 Sanctions and Restrictive Measures

Please confirm whether there are currently United Nations Security Council (UNSC) restrictive measures in force within any of the beneficiary countries. If yes, describe the restrictive measures and provide further information as to how the readiness funding recipient will ensure compliance with the scope of any UNSC sanctions regimes. Please provide sanction assurance letter.

7.6 Grievance Redress Mechanisms

Please confirm whether mechanisms are available for third parties or anonymous persons to report allegations of possible wrongdoing in the projects/activities (i.e. a whistle-blower protection programme) and describe applicable grievance redress mechanisms (GRM)

8. Budget

8.1 Budget

The DAE (for the DAE Support Window) is required to prepare and submit the Budget for the proposal period. Please complete the Budget using the specified Excel template.

As necessary, provide an accompanying narrative (text) explanation in this section of the proposal. If not necessary, please indicate “Refer to the Excel file”.

The Budget must include a disbursement schedule linked to deliverables and aligned with the Implementation Plan. Use the Budget narrative to explain and justify the figures as needed.

 [Download template](#)

Budget plan (please complete in the separate document)

While developing the budget, please consider the ineligible costs as per page 13 of the Initial Guide for Countries to Access Readiness Support

9. Other relevant information

9.1 Exit and Sustainability Strategy

This strategy should clearly demonstrate how the capacity-building efforts provided through the readiness support will lead to an enhancement in the institutional capabilities of the readiness support beneficiaries. Key components of this strategy must include:

Capacity Building and Institutionalization:

Describe what targeted training programmes are planned that are focused on key skills and competencies of the DAE and relevant stakeholders under the DAE Support Window.

Describe what tools, templates and instruments will be produced that beneficiaries can integrate into their daily operations

Describe how capacity-building initiatives will be adapted to local contexts to ensure relevance and ownership

Integration into National Systems:

Describe how readiness support will enhance existing policies and frameworks

Describe how readiness support will ensure enhanced institutional roles and/or practices will be integrated into the national/entity framework

Sustainability Mechanisms:

Describe whether sustainable training and imparting of knowledge and skills is introduced in this proposal, such as based on a "train-the-trainer" approach

Describe knowledge-sharing platforms or practices for continuous learning

9.2 Readiness Programme Closure

Describe effective transition of all tangible and intangible assets to ensure the sustainability of the outcomes post readiness activities. This must include an Asset Transfer Plan, which is a proposed plan for the completion of the grant activities, to systematically transfer all tangible and intangible assets, including equipment, technology, intellectual property and any developed resources, to the designated beneficiaries or other entities as identified by the DAE (under the DAE Support Window). The transfer process should be clearly documented and agreed upon by all parties, ensuring that the beneficiaries are fully prepared to take ownership and responsibility for these assets.